

Dear East Sussex County Council Hiring Team,

I'm excited to apply for the Senior Data Analyst position at Transport for the South East. Richard Arnold at UCL passed this opportunity on to me from Joshua Jiao at TfSE. The mix of spatial data analysis and strategic transport planning is a great fit for both my research background and my professional experience.

I'm finishing up my MSc in Urban Spatial Science at CASA UCL. For my industry-sponsored dissertation with CACI Ltd, I'm exploring how the types of urban environments can help predict retail spending patterns across UK cities, using tools like Python, GeoPandas, scikit-learn, and spatial autocorrelation analysis. Working with large, varied national datasets and communicating results to a commercial sponsor has given me practical experience in the kind of evidence-based analysis TfSE values—turning complex data into straightforward insights that non-technical decision-makers can use.

Before starting my MSc, I spent five years as a Team Leader at Derman Verbakel Architecture in Tel Aviv. I handled geo-computational workflows in QGIS across about fifteen projects for both municipal and private clients. For example, I worked on a transportation masterplan for the Eilat Municipality, collaborating with local transport authorities to turn spatial analysis into planning recommendations, much like the work TfSE does with local partners. I also created spatial data reports and visualisations for planning committees and senior stakeholders and developed automated GIS workflows that boosted our office's efficiency by 30%.

My technical skills include Python, QGIS, ArcGIS, GeoPandas, SQL, and data visualisation. I'm comfortable working with large surveys and demographic datasets, and I have plenty of experience managing multiple projects—even when deadlines are tight. I've also led teams under pressure, and I believe the most valuable skill is finding smart, efficient ways to approach challenges and staying curious about how things work.

I'm especially interested in this role because it would let me work with the 2026 Regional Travel Survey and contribute to strategic transport planning at a regional level—from the public sector side. So far, I've only experienced this kind of work from the private sector, and I'm excited to bring that perspective over. I know this work can make a real difference for communities across the South East. Having worked with municipal clients, I've seen how valuable it is when data analysis leads to policy changes that matter. I'm also comfortable working with investors and entrepreneurs, so I can find strategies that work well for everyone involved and communicate easily with a range of stakeholders.

Thank you for considering my application.

Warm regards,

Emily Deeb

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